

Working with dropdown lists in JavaScript

In this lesson, we will learn how to work with the `select` tag, which is a dropdown list. If you don't know how to work with this tag in HTML, then first study this tag in the manual at this link: [select](#).

Let's see how to work with this tag through JavaScript. Let's say we have a dropdown list like this:

```
1 <select id="select">
2   <option>one</option>
3   <option selected>two</option>
4   <option>three</option>
5 </select>
```

Get a reference to the select into a variable:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
```

Let's now display the text of the selected list item when changing the select. To do this, we need to read the value property of our select:

```
1 select.addEventListener('change', function(){
2   console.log(this.value);
3 });
```

№1

⊗jsPmSlInr

Given a select, a paragraph, and a button. By clicking on the button, display the text of the selected list item in a paragraph.

№2

⊗jsPmSlInr

Make a dropdown list of years from 2020 to 2030. When you select any item in the list, display a message about whether this year is a leap year or not.

Value attribute of dropdown lists in JavaScript

As a rule, the attribute `value` is added to list items. In this case, the value property of the select will not contain the text `option`, but the value of its `value` attribute.

Let's rewrite our select:

```
1 <select id="select">
2   <option value="1">one</option>
3   <option value="2" selected>two</option>
4   <option value="3">three</option>
5 </select>
```

Let's check what the selected value is now equal to:

```
1 select.addEventListener('change', function(){
2   console.log(this.value);
3 });
```

№ 1

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Make a dropdown list with the names of the days of the week. As `value` attributes of the list items, add the numbers of the days of the week from 1 to 7. After changing the list, display a message on the screen indicating whether the selected day is a weekend or a workday.

Changing the selected list item in JavaScript

In the previous lesson, we learned how to get the selected list item. Let's now change the selected item using JavaScript.

To do this, in the property `value` of the select, we write the value of the `value` attribute of the `option` that we want to select.

Suppose we have the following select:

```
1 <select id="select">
2   <option value="one">one</option>
3   <option value="two" selected>two</option>
4   <option value="three">three</option>
5 </select>
```

Let's also have a button:

```
1 <input type="submit" id="button">
```

Get references to the select and the button into variables:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
2 let button = document.querySelector('#button');
```

And now let's make it so that when the button is clicked, our select changes the selection:

```
1 button.addEventListener('click', function() {
2   select.value = 'one';
3 });
```

If our list does not have `value` attributes, then we need to write the text of the `option` tag that we want to select into the `value` property of the select.

№ 1

⊗jsPmSIS1Ch

Make a dropdown list with the names of the months. Make JavaScript select the current month from this list by default.

The number of the selected dropdown list item

In selects, there is a special property `selectedIndex` that stores the number of the list item that is currently selected. The numbering starts from zero. At the same time, this property can be both read and written by changing the selected list item.

Let's see how this property works with an example. Let's say we have the following dropdown list:

```
1 <select id="select">
2   <option value="one">one</option>
3   <option value="two" selected>two</option>
4   <option value="three">three</option>
5 </select>
```

Let's display the number of the selected list item:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
2 console.log(select.selectedIndex); // shows 1
```

Now let's choose some other item:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
2 select.selectedIndex = 2; // shows 'three'
```

№ 1

⊗jsPmSISIN

Given input and select. A number is entered into the input. When focus is lost, select the list item whose number is equal to the value from the input.

№ 2

⊗jsPmSISIN

Make a dropdown list with the names of the days of the week. Make JavaScript select by default the current day from this list.

Getting dropdown list items in JavaScript

Let's say we have a dropdown list:

```
1 <select id="select">
2   <option value="one">one</option>
3   <option value="two">two</option>
4   <option value="three">three</option>
5 </select>
```

Question: how do we get all the items in this list? The easiest way is to use the appropriate selector:

```
1 let options = document.querySelectorAll('#select option');
2 console.log(options);
```

The search for `option` tags can be provided not in the entire document, but specifically in our select:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
2 let options = select.querySelectorAll('option');
3 console.log(options);
```

Advanced method of getting dropdown list items in JavaScript

When working with selects, there is the following feature: the variable that stores the reference to the select is an array, the elements of which are the `option` tags. This means that this variable can be looped over:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
2
3 for (let option of select) {
4   console.log(option);
5 }
```

Well, or just turn to the item with the desired number:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
2 console.log(select[0]);
```



№ 1

⊗jsPmSHIAA

Loop through all the items in the list and add the value of its `value` attribute to the end of the text of each item.

Working with dropdown list items in JavaScript

Let us have a reference to the `option` tag in a variable. For example, obtained as follows:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
2 let option = select[0];
```

In this case, the `text` property will store the text of the option, the `value` property will store the value of the attribute of the same name, and the `selected` property will store the value of `true` or `false` depending on whether the list item is selected or not:

```
1 console.log(option.text);
2 console.log(option.value);
3 console.log(option.selected);
```

№ 1

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Go through the list items in a loop and add an exclamation mark to the end of the text for the selected item, and a question mark for unselected items.

Selecting a list item in JavaScript

In previous lessons, we accessed the `select` tag to get or change the selected list item. It's not really necessary. After all, you can directly set the property `selected` of some `option` tag to `true`.

For example, let's make the list item with number two selected:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');
2 let option = select[2];
3 option.selected = true;
```

№ 1

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Given a dropdown list and a button. By clicking on the button, make selected the last item in the list.

Getting the selected option in JavaScript

Using everything learned, you can get the selected [option](#) tag as follows:

```
1 let select = document.querySelector('#select');  
2 console.log(select[select.selectedIndex]);
```

№ 1

⊗jsPmSISOG

Given a select and a button. By pressing the button, display the text of the marked list item.

№ 2

⊗jsPmSISOG

Given a select and a button. Add an exclamation mark to the end of the selected item text when you click the button.

Result of code execution:

open in a new child window

See also

the [clientY](#) property
that determines the mouse coordinates along the Y axis

the [pageX](#) property
that determines the mouse coordinates along the X axis

the [pageY](#) property
that determines the mouse coordinates along the Y axis